Homegrown

INTERNAL PLAYBOOK

# The First 7 Days: Getting Vendors to Their First Sale

Master Onboarding Playbook — March 2026

Goal: Maximize trial-to-paid conversion, time to first sale (TTFO), and annual plan adoption

| 42-50% | 73% | 0 | 90% |
|---|---|---|---|
| Trial-to-paid (current) | Choose annual plan (current) | Confirmed vendor orders (problem) | Product creation abandonment (problem) |

## 1. The Critical Path

- **To receive orders, vendors need:** (1) at least 1 pickup location, (2) at least 1 product. That's it.
- **The activation moment is NOT setup complete — it's the FIRST ORDER.** Everything after setup must engineer toward sharing the store link.
- **85% of signups are Social Sellers (ICP1) and Farmstand/Porch sellers (ICP2),** not market vendors. The onboarding must speak to all three.

## 2. Hour-by-Hour Playbook

For each touchpoint: what fires, on what channel, its current status, and what's needed to make it live.

## HOUR 0 — Signup Complete

Vendor just created their account and landed on the dashboard

### EMAIL TOUCHES

| EMAIL | SUBJECT | STATUS | WHAT NEEDS TO HAPPEN |
|---|---|---|---|
| **V1** Welcome | "Welcome to Homegrown!" | LIVE (needs refresh) | Refresh: change Step 1 from "Add product" to "Add location". Add trial end date. Add storefront URL. |
| **V3** Trial Start | "Your 7-day free trial just started" | LIVE (needs refresh) | Refresh: lead with trial end date, include 3-step checklist, add dashboard GIF. |

### DASHBOARD

| ELEMENT | CURRENT STATE | PROPOSED STATE | STATUS |
|---|---|---|---|
| Tour modal | "Take the Vendor Dashboard Tour" — 100% dismissed | REMOVE entirely | NEEDS REMOVAL |
| Progress checklist | Does not exist | 3-step checklist: Location → Product → Share | NEEDS DEV |
| Trial countdown | Not visible anywhere | "Your free trial ends [DATE] — 7 days left" banner at top | NEEDS DEV |
| Sidebar | 9 items shown to new vendors | Simplify to 4 during onboarding (Dashboard, Products, Locations, My Account) | NEEDS DEV |

### INTERCOM

| ELEMENT | CURRENT STATE | PROPOSED STATE | STATUS |
|---|---|---|---|
| Checklist | "Business Information" (profile details) | Replace with "Get your first order" — 3 steps: Location, Product, Share | SUPPORT TASK |

### PRODUCT (FORM UX)

| ELEMENT | CURRENT STATE | PROPOSED STATE | STATUS |
|---|---|---|---|

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| Product form | 8 fields, images required, SKU prominent | 3 required fields (Name, Category, Price), everything else collapsed | NEEDS DEV |
| Image upload | Required to submit — blocks every mobile vendor | Auto-placeholder: when vendor selects a category, product gets a category-matched placeholder image automatically (e.g. Bakery → bread icon on warm background). Product is publishable immediately. Microcopy: "Don't worry, you can add a photo or edit this later." Real photo replaces placeholder when uploaded. | NEEDS DEV |
| Validation | Premature red errors on untouched fields | Validate on blur/submit only | NEEDS DEV |
| Location banner | Covers submit button on mobile | Hide during product creation | NEEDS DEV |

## HOUR 0 + 2 HOURS — No Product Yet

Vendor signed up but hasn't created a product

| TOUCH | DETAILS | STATUS |
|---|---|---|
| **Email V5** | **Subject:** "Your store needs one thing to go live"<br>**Trigger:** subscribed +2h, 0 products<br>**CTA:** "Add your first product" | HTML EXISTS — NOT WIRED<br>Template at V5-vendor-add-product-nudge-1.html. Needs: register in SendGrid + build trigger logic. |

## HOUR 0 + 6 HOURS — Still No Product

Photo anxiety is the likely blocker

| TOUCH | DETAILS | STATUS |
|---|---|---|
| **Email V6** | **Subject:** "Your phone camera is all you need"<br>**Trigger:** +6h, 0 products (suppress if V5 converted)<br>**Angle:** Photo anxiety — reassure that phone photos are fine | HTML EXISTS — NOT WIRED |

## HOUR 0 + 12 HOURS — Still No Product

Form complexity is the likely blocker

| TOUCH | DETAILS | STATUS |
|---|---|---|
| **Email V7** | **Subject:** "Just 4 fields. Everything else is optional."<br>**Trigger:** +12h, 0 products<br>**Angle:** Form complexity — emphasize minimal requirements | HTML EXISTS — NOT WIRED |

## DAY 1 — Has Product, No Location

Product created but no pickup location set

| TOUCH | DETAILS | STATUS |
|---|---|---|
| **Email V8** | **Subject:** "Your store has products but no pickup — let's fix that"<br>**Trigger:** 1+ products, 0 locations, +24h<br>**CTA:** "Add a pickup location" | HTML EXISTS — NOT WIRED |

## DAY 2 — Has Product + Location, No Description

Core setup done but profile incomplete

| TOUCH | DETAILS | STATUS |
|---|---|---|
| **Email V9** | **Subject:** "Tell customers who you are — it takes 3 minutes"<br>**Trigger:** has product + location, no description, +48h | HTML EXISTS — NOT WIRED |

## DAY 2-3 — Setup Complete, 0 Orders

The critical activation gap — vendor needs to SHARE their link

| TOUCH | DETAILS | STATUS |
|---|---|---|
| **Email V10** | **Subject:** "Your store is ready. Here's how to get your first order."<br>**Trigger:** full setup, 0 orders, +72h<br>**CTA:** "Copy your store link" | HTML EXISTS — NOT WIRED |
| **Email V11**<br>THE ACTIVATION EMAIL | **Subject:** "Your store is live — here's exactly how to share it"<br>**Must include:** 4 copy-paste templates (Text, Instagram, Facebook, Email)<br>**Trigger:** has product AND location | EXISTS HIGH PRIORITY REFRESH<br>Current version is generic. Must add copy-paste share templates. |

### COPY-PASTE SHARE TEMPLATES FOR V11

#### TEXT TO REGULARS

*"Hey! I just set up an online store so you can order from me anytime — not just at the market. Check it out: [YOUR LINK]. Order by [DAY] for pickup on [DAY]."*

#### INSTAGRAM POST

*"Big news! You can now order my [PRODUCT] online anytime. No more 'save me one!' DMs 😊 Link in bio: [YOUR LINK] #shoplocal #homegrown"*

#### FACEBOOK POST

*"I just launched my online store! If you've ever wanted to order between markets, now you can. [YOUR LINK] — orders open now."*

#### EMAIL TO CUSTOMERS

**Subject: "You can now order from me online"**

*"Hi! I wanted to let you know I set up an online ordering page. You can browse my products, place an order, and pick up at [LOCATION]. Here's the link: [YOUR LINK]"*

## DAY 3-4 — 0 Orders Still

Vendor has setup complete but no traction

| TOUCH | DETAILS | STATUS |
|---|---|---|
| **Email V14-NEW** | **Subject:** "5 ways to get your first order this week"<br>**5 tactics:** text 5 regulars, post on Instagram, add to bio, print on card, tell people at market | HTML EXISTS — NOT WIRED |

## DAY 5 — Trial Day 5

Urgency begins

| TOUCH | DETAILS | STATUS |
|---|---|---|
| **Email V17a** | **Subject:** "2 days left to get your first order"<br>If orders > 0: celebrate. If 0: urgency nudge with share CTA. | HTML EXISTS — NOT WIRED |

## DAY 6 — Trial Day 6

THE conversion email — highest-impact touchpoint for trial-to-paid

| TOUCH | DETAILS | STATUS |
|---|---|---|
| **Email V17b**<br>THE CONVERSION EMAIL | **Subject:** "Your store goes offline tomorrow"<br>**Frame:** LOSS — "Your store at [URL] with [X] products goes offline tomorrow. Your [X] profile views disappear."<br>**Primary CTA:** "Keep My Store — $10/mo annual"<br>**Secondary:** "$12.50/mo monthly" | HTML EXISTS — NOT WIRED<br>**Highest-impact missing email for trial conversion.** |

> **Loss aversion is 2x more motivating than gain.** "Your store goes offline" > "Your trial is ending." Always lead with the annual plan ($10/mo) as the primary CTA.

## DAY 7 — Trial End

Final conversion window

| TOUCH | DETAILS | STATUS |
|---|---|---|
| **Email V17c** | **Subject:** "Your free trial ends today"<br>Simple, direct. Two CTAs: Annual $10/mo (primary) and Monthly $12.50/mo (secondary). | HTML EXISTS — NOT WIRED |
| **System** | If payment method present: auto-converts to paid. If not: V18 fires (exists). | LIVE |

## DAY 14 — Founder Check-in

Personal touch from Evan

| TOUCH | DETAILS | STATUS |
|---|---|---|
| **Email V21** | **Subject:** "Quick check-in from Evan"<br>Plain text, personal, from evan@findhomegrown.com. "Have you gotten any orders? Reply and I'll personally help." | HTML EXISTS — NOT WIRED |

## 3. Annual Conversion Strategy

73% of vendors already choose the annual plan without any active promotion. Here's how to push that higher:

| TOUCHPOINT | STRATEGY |
|---|---|
| **Day 6 email (V17b)** | Lead with annual: "Keep your store — $10/mo" as primary CTA. Monthly ($12.50) as secondary, smaller text. |
| **Day 7 email (V17c)** | Same dual-CTA structure. Annual primary, monthly secondary. |
| **Post-first-order celebration** | Include annual nudge: "Lock in $10/mo for a year." Ride the dopamine of the first sale. |
| **Day 30 — Monthly vendors (V46)** | Annual Upgrade Nudge: "You've paid $12.50 this month. Switch to annual and save $30/year." |
| **Pricing discipline** | **Never discount.** $10/mo is already the lowest in market. 90% of subscriptions sell at full price (Adapty data). |

## 4. What Needs to Happen (Build List)

Three categories ranked by who can execute and priority level.

### Category A: Support Person Can Do Now (Intercom)

1. **Remove the tour modal video** — 100% of vendors dismiss it immediately
2. **Replace "Business Information" checklist** with "Get your first order" (3 steps: Location, Product, Share)
3. **Set checklist notification style to Snippet** — less intrusive, higher engagement

### Category B: Email Team Can Do Now (SendGrid + Triggers)

1. **Refresh V11 (Share Your Profile) with copy-paste templates** — HIGHEST PRIORITY
2. **Register V5, V17b, V17c templates** in SendGrid
3. **Work with dev team to build trigger logic** for time-delay + completion-state checks
4. **Refresh V1** to change step order (location first, not product first)

### Category C: Dev Team (Product Changes)

1. **Auto-placeholder images by category** — when vendor selects a category (Bakery, Produce, Honey, etc.), product automatically gets a category-matched placeholder image. Product is publishable immediately. Real photo replaces placeholder when uploaded. Microcopy under image area: "Don't worry, you can add a photo or edit this later." Dev effort: one conditional — `onCategorySelect → set product.image = categoryPlaceholders[category]`
2. Reduce **product form to 3 visible fields** (Name, Category, Price)
3. Add **trial countdown** to dashboard
4. Fix **premature validation** on product form
5. Hide **"Add Location" banner** during product creation
6. Add **3 Intercom trackEvent calls** (location_added, product_added, store_link_shared)
7. Replace **tour modal with progress checklist** in dashboard
8. Add **first-product celebration moment**

## 5. Success Metrics

| METRIC | CURRENT | 30-DAY TARGET | 90-DAY TARGET |
|---|---|---|---|
| Time to first product | 20-45 min | < 10 min | < 5 min |
| Product creation completion | ~10% | 50% | 80% |
| % vendors who share link | Unknown (0% tracked) | 40% | 60% |
| Time to first sale (TTFO) | Never (0 orders) | 72 hours | 48 hours |
| Trial-to-paid | 42-50% | 55% | 65% |
| Annual plan adoption | 73% | 80% | 85% |
| 30-day retention | 87% | 90% | 93% |
| MRR | ~$150 | $350 | $700 |

## 6. Key Gaps Flagged

**14 of 16 planned emails exist as HTML but are NOT registered or triggered** — no backend automation is in place for the nudge sequence.

**"72 hours to first order" claim in V1 welcome email is unverified** — 0 orders confirmed in session recordings.

**Email template file numbering doesn't match strategy doc numbering** — causes confusion when cross-referencing templates and plans.

**Share rate is entirely untracked** — the most critical activation action (sharing the store link) has no measurement whatsoever.

**ICP segmentation has not been applied to any live onboarding touchpoint** — all vendors get the same generic flow.

**No backend trigger logic exists for the nudge email sequence** — even if templates are registered in SendGrid, they can't fire without dev work on time-delay + completion-state checks.